

Step-by-step: Build the 60/40 layout in FancyZones

1. Open FancyZones editor.
2. Choose a layout type that allows custom sizing (PowerToys offers multiple layout templates and a custom option).
3. Set two zones:
 - Zone 1: ~60% width
 - Zone 2: ~40% width
4. Save the layout and assign it to your current monitor.

Step-by-step: Snap windows into zones

1. Open two apps (e.g., Word + browser).
 2. Drag Word window while holding the FancyZones modifier key (as configured in PowerToys).
 3. Drop into the 60% zone.
 4. Drag browser → drop into the 40% zone.
- Result: your “default work posture” becomes one action, not constant resizing.

8) Create a “WFH monitor” layout (laptop + external display)

In Indian WFH setups, the external monitor is often 24-inch 1080p or a budget 27-inch. That’s more space, which means you can design more specific zones:

A useful layout:

- Left: browser/research
 - Center: main work app
 - Right: chat/Teams/Slack
 - Optional bottom strip: music, downloads, file explorer
- FancyZones supports per-monitor layouts, so your laptop screen can have one layout while the external monitor has another. This is exactly where FancyZones shines.

Step-by-step: Assign different layouts per monitor

1. Open FancyZones editor.
2. Select the monitor you want to configure.
3. Apply a layout that suits that monitor’s width.
4. Repeat for the second monitor.

Pro move: keep the laptop screen as “Meetings/Communication” and the monitor as “Work canvas” so you’re not screen-sharing the wrong thing.

9) Multi-monitor taskbar sanity

Once you add a second monitor, Windows taskbar behavior matters. Microsoft’s official taskbar customization page explains that you can choose to show the taskbar on all displays, which puts taskbar access on each monitor.

Step-by-step: Show taskbar on all displays

1. Right-click the taskbar → Taskbar settings.

SNAP LAYOUTS + FANCYZONES: WHEN TO USE WHICH?

Use **Snap Layouts** when:

- you’re on a new machine
- you need quick, standard splits
- you don’t want to configure anything
- you’re in “get it done now” mode

Use **FancyZones** when:

- you repeat the same layout daily
- you want asymmetrical splits (60/40, 70/30, etc.)
- you use ultrawide or multiple monitors
- you want consistent window positions across sessions

Fast Track rule: don’t over-engineer. Start with Snap Layouts. Upgrade to FancyZones when you feel the pain.

2. Expand Taskbar behaviors.
3. Enable Show my taskbar on all displays.
4. Configure where taskbar app buttons appear across displays (options vary by build).

Why it matters: if your taskbar only “lives” on one display, you end up dragging your mouse back and forth just to launch apps. This single toggle removes that friction.

10) Three practical “window recipes” you can copy today

Recipe A: Student “Study Stack”

- Left: PDF / lecture slides
 - Right: notes (Word/OneNote/Notion)
 - Small floating: calculator or browser for quick definitions
- Build with Snap Layouts first.

Recipe B: Office “WFH Control Room”

- Main monitor: Excel/Docs center + browser side
 - Laptop screen: Teams + calendar + notes
- Enable taskbar on all displays for speed.

Recipe C: Developer “Build + Run”

- Left: IDE (big zone)
- Right top: docs/browser
- Right bottom: terminal/logs

This is a perfect FancyZones layout because it’s asymmetrical and repeatable. 